

2nd Upminster (St. Laurence) Scout Group

Guide to the Constitution for parents and carers

Every Scout Group within the Scouts' federation of charities must have an agreed constitution and we are strongly encouraged by The Scout Association to adopt the model constitution published in Chapters 5b and 5c of its Policy, Organisation and Rules ("POR").

The guide below explains, in simple terms, how our Scout Group is organised and overseen. You can find the entire text of POR Chapters 5b and 5c here:

<https://www.scouts.org.uk/por/5b-local-governance-of-groups-districts-and-counties/>

<https://www.scouts.org.uk/por/5c-constitutions-of-groups-districts-and-counties-except-in-scotland/>

Parent Guide: How Our Scout Group Is Run

This guide is based on the formal Scouts rules for Group governance but is written for parents and carers who want to understand the basics.

- Our Scout Group exists to help young people grow in confidence, skills and character, and to make a positive contribution to society.
- The Group is supported by volunteers who make sure it is run safely, legally and in the best interests of young people.
- A Group Trustee Board oversees governance, finance, risk, insurance and compliance so that leaders can focus on delivering great Scouting.
- The Group Scout Council provides oversight and makes key appointments, including trustees such as the Chair and Treasurer.
- An Annual General Meeting (AGM) is held each year to review the Group's work, finances and appointments.
- The Trustee Board must make sure money and resources are managed responsibly and that proper records and reports are kept.
- Young people should be meaningfully involved in decision making wherever possible.
- Meetings must be properly run and recorded, with clear rules on voting, quorum and decision making.

What this means for parents and carers

For families, this means there is a clear structure behind the scenes to make sure the Group is well led and accountable. The adults responsible for governance are expected to manage funds carefully, follow Scouts policies and the law, look after buildings and equipment, and help create a safe, well-run environment for all young people. In short, the constitution helps ensure that the Group is stable, transparent and focused on delivering a high-quality programme.

If you would like to know more about how our Scout Group is managed, please speak to a Group Leader or Trustee Board member, who can explain how these arrangements work locally.